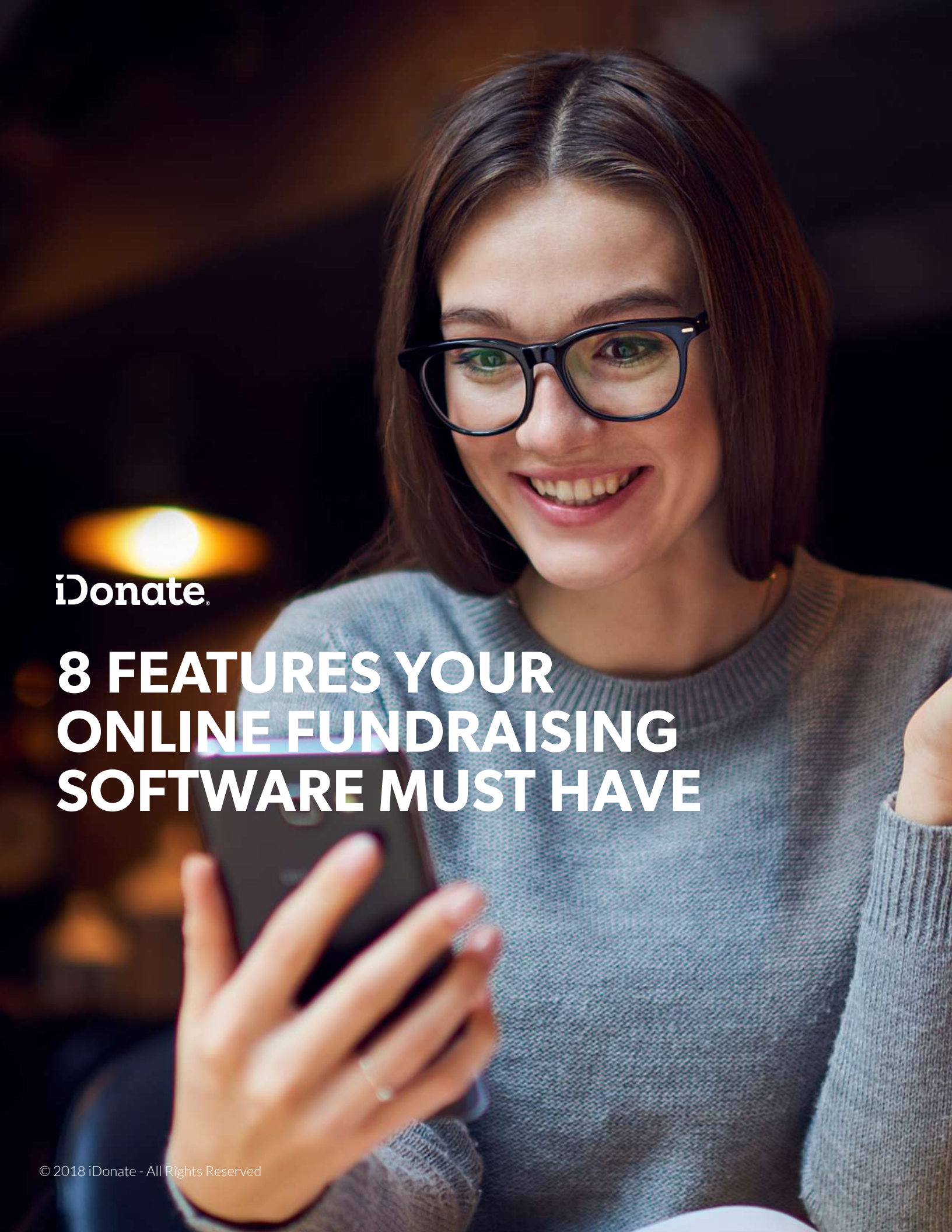


iDonate®

8 FEATURES YOUR ONLINE FUNDRAISING SOFTWARE MUST HAVE

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8 MUST-HAVE FEATURES OF ONLINE FUNDRAISING SOFTWARE

Online giving is the fastest growing fundraising channel for nonprofits, increasing by 7% despite a relatively flat giving growth rate of only 1-3%, according to a 2017 report.[1]

Based on research gleaned from hundreds of nonprofits and giving systems, we have compiled the 8 essential features that online fundraising software must have in order to meet the essential needs of donors and nonprofits – from the world's largest organizations to one-man startups.

1. IT MUST BE EASY FOR DONORS TO GIVE A GIFT.

Believe it or not, there are still many online fundraising software options that make it incredibly difficult for your donors to give a gift. Your online fundraising software must not force donors to register or go through multiple pages to make a gift. This is called "friction," and it dissuades your donors (who may come to the page highly motivated) from completing the process.

Your online fundraising software must remove hurdles to donating– not increase them. It should be an easy, pleasant experience for donors to give a gift. If your online fundraising software doesn't make it easy for donors to give a gift, they will give elsewhere – or not at all.

2. YOU MUST BE ABLE TO EMBED DONATION FORMS DIRECTLY INTO YOUR SITE.

Many online fundraising software providers force you to send donors to a secure page on their site to make a gift. This increases donor's anxiety – and they become uncertain that their gift is going to the right place. Many of the web templates used by third parties are also rigid and allow for little, if any, customization.

[1]NPEngage

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About iDonate

iDonate® is the leading digital donor engagement solution created to empower enterprise-level nonprofit organizations to build and personalize relationships with today's donors through cutting-edge SaaS technology, superior giving experiences, omnichannel fundraising, and growth services.

iDonate's mission is to transform charitable giving and drive growth for our partners so they can make bigger impacts on the world.

Make sure that your online fundraising software can function through an embeddable widget directly on your site. This allows you to place a donation form on as many pages as you need and ensures that donors know they are in the right place. Mobile For Good found that organizations with an embedded form raise 6 times more money than organizations that send donors to a third-party site.[2]

3. YOU MUST BE ABLE TO CLEARLY SEE RESULTS

As Peter Drucker famously said, "What gets measured gets managed." To manage and grow your online fundraising, your software must give you instant access to analytics in a way that is easy to see. Your online fundraising software must provide a dashboard in the backend for you to see and interpret the data.

Even some of the largest online fundraising software providers force you to download spreadsheets and work with the raw data to get answers. Raw data is good in some situations, but it takes time to analyze. When you are in a campaign, you often must make instant decisions – and your online fundraising software should enable that.

In addition to the dashboard, your online fundraising software should allow you to instantly download the data in multiple formats (CSV, Excel, PDF) for further analysis or sharing.

4. YOU MUST BE ABLE TO INTEGRATE GIVING DATA WITH YOUR CRM OR DMS

Donor data is useless if you can't attach it to donor records in a cus-tomer relationship management (CRM) system or donor management system (DMS). If your online fundraising software does not integrate with your CRM or DMS, then you face the task of having to manually import gifts – which dramatically slows down your response time, greatly increases the possibility of human error, and makes a one-to-one connection impossible.



Organizations with an embedded form raise 6x more money than organizations that send donors to a third-party site.[2]

[2] Mobile For Good: A How-To Fundraising Guide for Nonprofits

Today's donors expect a personal connection to the brands they interact with, based on their passions, friends and shared experiences, which requires 360-degree visibility into donors that is only possible when you can integrate their data together.

Sometimes fundraising software can integrate with your CRM or DMS if you're willing to spend hundreds of thousands of dollars in custom development. Many online fundraising software providers will say, "Yes, we integrate with that," but they make your organization do the work. Make sure your online fundraising software company handles the integration for you.

5. YOU MUST BE ABLE TO CONTROL THE LOOK AND FEEL OF YOUR DONATION FORMS

This seems like a small thing, but it's more important than you think. Branding matters. It's important that your donor has a consistent experience. If a donor clicks a banner ad for your organization, goes to a landing page, makes a donation on the page, receives a receipt and a thank you email, each of these interactions should have a consistent, branded experience throughout. Not only does this decrease donor anxiety (and increase your organization's credibility), it makes it easier for a donor to mentally commit to giving a gift.

Many third party providers force you to go to an unbranded page (or worse, a page that has the brand of the software provider). Breaking this continuity or limiting customization affects the donor experience and reduces donations.

6. YOU MUST BE ABLE TO CUSTOMIZE YOUR GIFT ARRAY OPTIONS & DESIGNATIONS

You should be able to set your gift array for any amount, in any order, with any designation. If you want to send an appeal to major donors but your online fundraising software forces you to ask them for $25 gifts rather than basing the array on their previous contribution of $1,000, that's a big problem. These fields should be flexible.

$43.6 billion in noncash gifts like cars, boats, and stocks are given to nonprofits each year.

Are you getting your share?

7. YOU MUST BE ABLE TO ACCEPT MORE THAN CREDIT CARD DONATIONS

Did you know that $43.6 billion in noncash gifts like cars, boats, and stocks are given to nonprofits each year? More than 10% of annual charitable giving is in the form of noncash gifts. If your donation form restricts you to credit cards and e-checks, you're leaving a lot of money on the table.

iDonate is currently the only online fundraising software that allows you to accept these gifts right on your form. iDonate manages all of the transfer, processing, liquidation and receipting work for the items you receive and send you the check, so you don't have to become a used car dealer, stockbroker, or an expert on IRS receipting rules.

8. YOU MUST BE ABLE TO SHOW YOUR DONORS THE IMPACT OF THEIR GIFT

Studies have shown that when donors see the specific impact of their gift (i.e. $30 provides 40 lbs. of food), they are more likely to give (and give again, later).

Some online fundraising software platforms let you list the impact of the gift next to each giving level and choose icons that fit your industry. Others calculate the impact as the donor makes the gift. Either way, the donor must immediately see the concrete difference they are making in the world through their gift.

HOW DOES YOUR ONLINE GIVING SOFTWARE STACK UP?

Finding the right online fundraising software can be a frustrating process. There are many factors to consider, but these core features are the most critical to modern fundraising in a digital world.

Find how iDonate can take your giving to the next level.

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